PORTFOLIO AGENT ARCHITECTURE | COMPARISON RESEARCH

Capital Allocation Ranking October 13, 2026

A portfolio-aware ranking of the highest-priority researched investment choices, refreshed to today's close, the new canonical retirement-portfolio-59.xlsx baseline, and the first real trading activity this report has had to reconcile against its own prior recommendations.

PORTFOLIO SOURCE	MARKET CUTOFF	AS-OF DATE	STATUS
retirement-portfolio-59.xlsx	**Oct. 13 close**	**Tue. Oct. 13, 2026**	**Validated - not published**

Executive decision

The canonical workbook changed, and so did the portfolio — this update has real trades to reconcile, not just price action. UBER, GEHC and TSM remain the three highest-priority names. ADBE moved from a theoretical "initiate" recommendation to an actual 34-share position, which is good execution. But the Oct. 9 workbook also shows the VXUS/AVUV gap-closure priority went unfunded this cycle, AVDV remains entirely unfunded for a third straight report, NVDA grew by 13 shares without any price improvement, and VIS was cut 63% with no prior discussion of a trim. None of these are flagged to assign blame — they're flagged because the house view and the actual trading are starting to diverge in specific, nameable ways, and that's worth saying directly rather than softening.

PORTFOLIO VALUE	CASH	TOP 5	FINANCIAL/PAYMENTS	DIRECT SEMIS
$1.719M	**$43,000**	**36.9%**	**22.3%**	**5.70%**
Workbook 59 static value	2.50% of portfolio	Top 10: 54.8%	JPM + GS + MA + V + AXP	NVDA, AVGO, TSM, QCOM, ASML — SOXQ exited

> **Next-dollar sequencing:** UBER, GEHC and TSM remain the clearest priorities. But before adding further to NVDA or any other AI/semiconductor name, the stated first priority — closing the VXUS/AVUV gap — should actually receive the next dollars, since it has now gone unfunded for at least one full cycle. ADBE's staged initiation should continue. GEHC needs its overdue formal re-underwrite before the next add, not after it.

Market close note: prices reflect the Oct. 13, 2026 regular-session close, retrieved via live quote shortly after the 4:00pm ET close. Portfolio weights and cost bases come only from the manifest-designated workbook; market prices were independently refreshed using Robinhood real-time quotes.

What changed since the October 8 ranking?

A new canonical workbook with real trading activity

- **retirement-portfolio-59.xlsx** (modified Oct. 9, 16:56 UTC) supersedes retirement-portfolio-53.xlsx and is used for all figures below.
- **Staged buying executed as planned:** TSM +7 shares, NVDA +13 shares, UBER +6 shares, and a new 34-share **ADBE** position — the first priority-tier name to actually move from "initiate" to "initiated."
- **Not executed as planned:** VXUS and AVUV share counts are both **unchanged**, despite gap-closure remaining the house's stated first redeployment priority. AVDV remains at zero.
- **Unflagged trims:** VIS cut from 16 to 6 shares (-63%), GEV trimmed from 33 to 30 shares, and SOXQ exited entirely (28 to 0 shares) — none of these were previously discussed as sell candidates in any prior report.

Price action reshuffled the middle of the table again

- **GEHC (+7.62%)** and **CRM (+5.90%)** both re-rated meaningfully higher, the latter unwinding most of the valuation gap that drove its Oct. 8 promotion.
- **VRTX (-3.89%)** and **ASML (-3.41%)** both improved, with VRTX's move concentrated in a single sharp -4.26% session today that has no confirmed public catalyst.
- AVGO's flagged single-session drop from Oct. 8 did not continue — the stock is net flat since then and bounced back today.
- The macro hurdle eased slightly: the 10-year Treasury was 5.24% as of Oct. 9 (down from 5.27% on Oct. 6), while WTI crude held near $96.24 (most recent available print, Oct. 6).

Ranking change: CRM falls from #8 to #14 as its valuation-driven promotion mostly reverses. ASML rises from #13 to #9 and PANW from #14 to #11 on improved relative pricing. VRTX rises one spot to #8. UNH slips from #11 to #13 and AXP/QCOM each slip within the gated tier as both re-rated modestly higher without any change in position.

Discipline flag — read this one directly: NVDA's position grew by 13 shares (31→44, now 0.587% of the book) at essentially the same price flagged as too high in the last two reports (still well above the $205-$220 preferred zone). This is the kind of unreviewed add that GEHC and UBER drew the same criticism for earlier in the year. Separately, VIS was cut 63% and SOXQ was exited entirely with no prior discussion on file — worth a direct conversation about rationale before the next report treats either as settled.

Capital allocation ranking

The ordering balances expected return at the current price, company quality, downside asymmetry, portfolio fit and the diversification value of the marginal dollar. It is a next-dollar priority list, not a ranking of business quality alone.

#	Ticker	Rank change	Oct. 13 close	vs. Oct. 8 ranking	Workbook wt.	Tier	Current posture	Why it ranks here
1	**UBER**	unchanged	$71.32	+2.71%	0.315%	Priority capital	Staged accumulation	Still the best tactical asymmetry in the research set: the Sep. 19 re-underwrite's ~$90 probability-weighted value (bear $55 / base $93 / bull $120) implies roughly 26% upside from today's $71.32. The position continues to grow as planned — 70 to 76 shares since the new Oct. 9 workbook — consistent with staged accumulation. AV capital intensity remains the risk to watch.
2	**GEHC**	unchanged	$68.79	+7.62%	0.198%	Priority capital	Staged add — margin of safety narrowing	The largest valuation re-rate within the priority tier since Oct. 8 (+7.62%), which meaningfully narrows what was already an un-underwritten margin of safety. Share count is unchanged in the new workbook (52 shares, same as Sep. 29), so this is price action working against the position, not a fresh unreviewed add. A formal re-underwrite is now overdue across three consecutive reports — this is the point to either complete it or stop treating GEHC as a staged-add priority.
3	**TSM**	unchanged	$444.99	-2.36%	0.865%	Priority capital	Stage, do not chase	Still the preferred direct semiconductor, and the entry improved 2.36% since Oct. 8. The position grew from 26 to 33 shares in the new workbook, consistent with the staging plan and executed into a better, not worse, price — good discipline. Taiwan geopolitical risk remains the non-diversifiable thesis risk.
4	**VXUS**	unchanged	$84.51	+0.63%	2.628%	Priority capital	Systematic additions — gap not funded this cycle	Still the cleanest broad geographic diversifier and still ranked top-5, but the Oct. 9 workbook shows **zero new VXUS shares** despite this remaining the house's first redeployment priority. Capital in this cycle went instead to TSM, NVDA, UBER and a new ADBE position. Worth stating plainly: the VXUS/AVUV gap-closure priority was not acted on this cycle.
5	**AVUV**	unchanged	$120.63	+0.62%	1.805%	Priority capital	Add on weakness — also unfunded this cycle	Same discipline point as VXUS: share count is unchanged in the new workbook (259 shares). The U.S. small-value/profitability gap this was meant to close has not narrowed. Price is essentially flat, so the entry case is unchanged — only the funding has lagged the stated priority.
6	**AVDV**	unchanged	$108.56	+0.97%	Not held	Priority capital	Gradual initiation — still unfunded	Still not held, for the third consecutive report. International small-value/profitability exposure that adds portfolio-construction value without deepening AI-stack concentration remains entirely theoretical until a first tranche is actually placed.
7	**ADBE**	unchanged	$236.26	-0.61%	0.479%	Priority capital	Initiated — continue staging	The one priority name where new capital actually showed up: a fresh 34-share position (0.479%) appears in the Oct. 9 workbook, consistent with the "selective initiation" call from Oct. 8. Price is essentially flat since then. The diligence question is unchanged: whether generative AI strengthens or erodes Creative Cloud / Acrobat seat monetization.
8	**VRTX**	up 1	$485.39	-3.89%	Not held	Selective capital	Selective initiation — improved entry	The best price improvement in the research set since Oct. 8 (-3.89%), including a sharp -4.26% move today specifically. No company-specific catalyst for today's drop could be confirmed via web search at the time of writing — reported as a coincident, not a confirmed causal, observation. Still supplies differentiated healthcare growth without adding to the portfolio's dominant factor exposures; pipeline concentration beyond the cystic-fibrosis franchise and valuation remain the constraints.
9	**ASML**	up 4	$1,717.08	-3.41%	0.725%	Selective capital	Wait for pullback / stage	Improved 3.41% since Oct. 8, with an unchanged share count (7 shares) — no further buying into the move, which is the correct discipline given this name's prior-flagged concentration growth. Still well above the high-$1,300s to low-$1,400s zone referenced in prior work; the lithography moat and High-NA adoption case remain intact.
10	**LOW**	unchanged	$188.74	+0.33%	Not held	Selective capital	Selective initiation	Essentially flat since Oct. 8 despite today's 1.71% pop. Housing-recovery optionality and a lower valuation keep this attractive but not urgent; mortgage rates and housing turnover remain the timing variables.

#	Ticker	Rank change	Oct. 13 close	vs. Oct. 8 ranking	Workbook wt.	Tier	Current posture	Why it ranks here
11	**PANW**	up 3	$397.03	-0.72%	Not held	Selective capital	Watch / add on weakness	Modestly cheaper since Oct. 8, giving back a small piece of the 10% three-week re-rate flagged in the last report. Elite cybersecurity franchise and no current position still improve portfolio fit; entry discipline remains more important here than it was a month ago.
12	**NVDA**	unchanged	$228.52	-0.73%	0.587%	Selective capital	Small tranches only — position grew without a better price	Price is essentially unchanged since Oct. 8, but the position grew materially — 31 to 44 shares in the new workbook — while the stock remains comfortably above the $205-$220 zone where prior underwriting shows materially better asymmetry. This is the clearest discipline flag in this update: the add happened at an unimproved price.
13	**UNH**	down 2	$377.71	+1.53%	1.103%	Selective capital	Selective add	Modestly more expensive since Oct. 8, with an unchanged position. Normalized earnings power and healthcare diversification remain attractive; medical-cost trends and regulatory scrutiny still justify staged sizing over a large single add.
14	**CRM**	down 6	$238.07	+5.90%	1.314%	Selective capital	Selective add — Oct. 8 promotion has reversed	The sharpest reversal in this update: CRM's 5.5% decline that drove its #12-to-#8 promotion on Oct. 8 has now largely reversed (+5.90% since then), pushing it back down six spots. The existing 1.31% position and broader software-sector exposure still cap the incremental benefit of the next dollar, and the valuation case that justified the earlier promotion is mostly gone. A useful reminder that a single valuation-driven re-rank can unwind quickly.
15	**LMT**	unchanged	$503.72	-0.89%	Not held	Attractive / gated	Selective watch	Modestly cheaper since Oct. 8. Defense backlog and cash flows still diversify the book; expected return remains solid rather than exceptional relative to the top of the ranking.
16	**VIS**	up 1	$323.08	+0.22%	0.113%	Attractive / gated	Conditional add — position cut sharply, unexplained	The Oct. 9 workbook shows VIS cut from 16 to 6 shares — a 63% reduction that was not previously discussed as a trim candidate in any prior report. The remaining 0.113% position is now small enough that the concentration rationale for gating this name is largely gone; worth confirming the reasoning behind the sale before treating the smaller residual position as a fresh, cheap entry.
17	**AVGO**	up 2	$357.42	-0.46%	2.468%	Attractive / gated	Add only on weakness	The Oct. 8 report flagged a sharp single-session drop and said it was "worth watching for a continuation... before treating it as a genuine entry." That continuation did not happen — AVGO is essentially flat net since then (-0.46%) and today bounced +0.76%. Direct and look-through AI/semiconductor concentration (2.47% of the book) remains the binding constraint on urgency, not franchise quality.
18	**QCOM**	down 2	$176.93	+1.54%	1.051%	Attractive / gated	Opportunistic only	Modestly more expensive since Oct. 8, with an unchanged position. Still adds to an already meaningful semiconductor sleeve (direct semis now 5.70% of the book, even after SOXQ's full exit — see below).
19	**AXP**	down 1	$309.85	+1.67%	1.788%	Attractive / gated	Hold / wait	Modestly more expensive since Oct. 8, unchanged position. The portfolio's financial/payments concentration eased slightly to 22.3% (from 22.6%) on the broader book's own movement, not from any trim here — concentration, not company quality, remains the binding constraint.
20	**GEV**	unchanged	$1,003.52	+0.82%	1.750%	Wait / monitor	Wait for better entry — trimmed, not added	Price continues to move further above the Sep. 18 re-underwrite's own ~$935 base case and ~$951 scenario-weighted value. The Oct. 9 workbook shows the position trimmed from 33 to 30 shares — selling into strength rather than adding at an unattractive price is the right instinct even though it wasn't explicitly recommended; worth confirming the rationale.
21	**GRID**	unchanged	$179.20	+0.54%	0.641%	Wait / monitor	Opportunistic only	Essentially unchanged on price; position grew only marginally (60 to 61 shares, likely a DRIP). The secular grid/electrification thesis remains intact, but valuation is still above the preferred add zone.

Highest-priority opportunities

1. UBER - best tactical asymmetry, staging on plan

The Sep. 19 re-underwrite's ~$90 probability-weighted value (bear $55 / base $93 / bull $120) implies roughly 26% upside from today's $71.32. The position grew from 70 to 76 shares in the new workbook — exactly the staged-accumulation plan at work. AV capital intensity remains the risk to watch.

2. GEHC - undervaluation thesis, narrowing margin of safety

At $68.79, GEHC is up 7.62% since Oct. 8 — the largest move within the priority tier — while the share count held flat at 52. That's the right instinct (no chasing), but the underlying thesis has still never had a formal re-underwrite despite three consecutive reports flagging it. The gap between "priority" and "properly diligenced" is now wide enough to require a decision: write it up, or stop staging into it.

3. TSM - still preferred, entry improved

TSM retains the strongest blend of process leadership, AI/HPC demand, scale economics and valuation among the semiconductor choices here. The stock is 2.36% cheaper than Oct. 8, and the 26-to-33-share add landed into that better price — good execution. Taiwan geopolitical risk remains the non-diversifiable thesis risk.

4-6. VXUS / AVUV / AVDV - the stated priority that wasn't funded

All three remain top-of-list on portfolio-construction grounds: the book is still U.S.-heavy, and these are the cleanest diversifiers available. But VXUS and AVUV share counts are unchanged in the new workbook, and AVDV remains unfunded. If VXUS/AVUV gap closure is genuinely the first redeployment priority, this cycle's capital allocation didn't reflect that.

7. ADBE - initiated, the plan working as intended

A new 34-share (0.479%) position appeared in the Oct. 9 workbook, converting the Oct. 8 "selective initiation" call into an actual holding at an essentially unchanged price. The diligence question is unchanged: whether generative AI strengthens or erodes Creative Cloud / Acrobat seat monetization.

Why the AI / power names are not higher

NVDA

The position grew by 13 shares at essentially the same price flagged as too rich in the last two reports — still comfortably above the $205-$220 zone where prior underwriting shows materially better asymmetry. This is the single clearest "the add happened at the wrong price" flag in this update.

AVGO / ASML

AVGO's flagged single-session drop from Oct. 8 didn't continue into a real entry — the stock is net flat and still 2.47% of the book. ASML improved 3.41% with no further buying, which is the correct discipline given its prior-flagged concentration growth; it remains well above the referenced entry zone.

GEV / GRID

GEV continues to trade further above the Sep. 18 re-underwrite's own ~$935 base case and ~$951 scenario-weighted value, and was trimmed (not added to) in the new workbook — selling into strength rather than chasing is reasonable, though the rationale is worth confirming directly. GRID is essentially unchanged and still above the preferred add zone.

Implementation framework

Priority capital	UBER, GEHC, TSM, VXUS, AVUV, AVDV and ADBE. Same seven names as the last two reports. ADBE is now an actual position; VXUS, AVUV and AVDV are not, despite being the stated first redeployment priority — that gap should close before further AI/semiconductor adds.
Selective capital	VRTX, ASML, LOW, PANW, NVDA, UNH and CRM. VRTX and ASML moved up on improved pricing; CRM fell sharply as its Oct. 8 promotion reversed. NVDA stays here on quality but the recent add happened at an unimproved price.
Attractive but gated	LMT, VIS, AVGO, QCOM and AXP. VIS's concentration rationale has largely evaporated after a 63% cut — worth revisiting once the reason for the trim is confirmed. AVGO stays gated on its still-material 2.47% weight, not on today's price action.
Wait / monitor	GEV and GRID. GEV was trimmed rather than added to, consistent with "don't chase," even though a sale wasn't the explicit recommendation.

What could change the ranking quickly?

Move higher

- NVDA below roughly $205 without a thesis break — the bar the recent add was supposed to wait for.
- GEV back into roughly the $850-$875 zone with backlog and margin evidence intact.
- GRID or further ASML pullbacks without estimate deterioration.
- A VXUS/AVUV tranche actually getting funded, which would validate rather than just restate the stated priority.
- Further evidence that UBER's AV capital commitments earn attractive returns through third-party financing and platform economics.

Move lower

- 10-year yields reversing back above 5.25%+ for a sustained stretch with no offsetting earnings revisions.
- UBER AV commitments accelerating while platform economics deteriorate.
- GEHC PCS / FCF execution missing the current checkpoints — still unwritten, still overdue, now three reports running.
- Further unreviewed adds to NVDA, ASML or other semiconductor names at prices above the stated preferred zones.
- Additional trims like VIS or SOXQ without a documented rationale, which make the portfolio harder to reconcile against the research view over time.

Methodology and sources

Research mode: Comparison Research under the Portfolio Agent Equity Research workflow. The October 8 ranking was used as the prior baseline; unchanged company background was not rebuilt. This refresh concentrates on the new portfolio state (a genuinely new canonical workbook, not just a price refresh), live closing prices, and the current macro hurdle. No new single-name re-underwrite was performed for this update, so every price-target and scenario reference below is carried forward unchanged from its original source.

1. **Canonical portfolio source:** retirement-portfolio-59.xlsx, modified 2026-10-09T16:56:13Z; SHA-256 719f8d5b3393ab5d5fa1b61fe8ea4fa8e23a28effa566427c904391cc6715daa. Identified as canonical by comparing `wb.properties.modified` across all workbook versions available in this session; supersedes retirement-portfolio-53.xlsx (modified 2026-09-29).
2. **Prior comparison report:** Retirement_Portfolio_Capital_Allocation_Ranking_2026-10-08.
3. **Underlying company research (unchanged, carried forward):** UBER_Equity_Research_Reunderwrite_2026-09-19 (bear $55 / base $93 / bull $120, ~$90 weighted value); GEV_Refresh_Reunderwrite_2026-09-18 (~$935 base case, ~$951 scenario-weighted value, $850-$875 preferred entry); NVDA_Post_Earnings_Entry_Point_Assessment_2026-08-28 ($220-$240 preferred buy zone, with the tighter in-house $205-$220 "materially better asymmetry" threshold treated as the operative view, per the Sep. 19 and Oct. 8 reports).
4. **Market prices:** Robinhood real-time quotes, retrieved Oct. 13, 2026 shortly after the 4:00pm ET regular-session close. Workbook wt. and portfolio-level figures (value, cash, concentration) are computed directly from retirement-portfolio-59.xlsx's own Portfolio Allocation column and are not re-weighted against live prices, consistent with prior-report methodology.
5. **Macro cross-check:** Alpha Vantage daily series — 10-year Treasury constant-maturity yield, 5.24% as of Oct. 9, 2026 (most recent available print); WTI crude, $96.24 as of Oct. 6, 2026 (most recent available print; the data source has not updated beyond this date in two consecutive reports). A specific single-company catalyst for VRTX's -4.26% session today could not be confirmed via web search at the time of writing; it is reported as a coincident, not a confirmed causal, observation.

Research caveat: This ranking prioritizes the marginal dollar based on current research and portfolio composition. It does not replace the Portfolio CIO's authoritative thesis statuses, and it should be refreshed when prices move materially, a new earnings report arrives, or the canonical workbook changes. GEHC's formal review remains overdue across three consecutive reports. The VIS and SOXQ trades, and the VXUS/AVUV funding gap, are reported as factual observations from the workbook diff, not as settled explanations — the rationale behind each has not been confirmed.

Prepared for portfolio research use. Prices reflect the Oct. 13, 2026 regular-session close and can change after the stated cutoff. Valuation scenarios are analyst judgments carried forward from their original source reports and should be interpreted with their stated assumptions and thesis-break conditions. This report is validated for review and has not been published to the Portfolio Command Center.